

Order Handoff Automation

Functional portfolio demonstration • HubSpot + Make.com + Google Sheets + Brevo

Project status

This is a functional portfolio demonstration built and tested with demonstration records. It is not a live client deployment and does not claim measured client results.

1. Project overview

When a salesperson marks a HubSpot deal as Closed Won, the sale is complete but the customer handoff is not. The workflow still needs to confirm the correct contact, prevent duplicate communication, send the welcome message, update the CRM, record the outcome and inform the internal team.

Business problem	Manual post-sale handoffs can miss steps, send duplicate welcome emails or hide failures.
Solution	A Make.com workflow that validates contact data, checks the deal ID before sending, performs the customer handoff and logs each outcome.
Tools	HubSpot, Make.com, Google Sheets and Brevo.
My role	Planning, workflow build, testing and documentation for the portfolio demonstration.

Scope

- In scope: HubSpot Closed Won trigger, deal and contact retrieval, contact/email checks, duplicate check, welcome email, HubSpot update, success/error logging and internal email.
- Out of scope: automatic retry, onboarding task creation, multiple email variants by deal type, production monitoring and live client deployment.

2. Implemented workflow

The implemented scenario uses a controlled sequence. Each important customer-facing action happens only after the required checks pass.

1	HubSpot Watch CRM Objects detects a deal entering Closed Won and starts the scenario.
2	The workflow retrieves the full deal and lists the associated HubSpot contact.
3	A router checks whether an associated contact exists. If not, the workflow logs Missing

	Contact and stops.
4	The contact is retrieved and a second router checks whether an email address exists. If not, Missing Email is logged and customer communication stops.
5	Google Sheets is searched for the HubSpot deal ID. If the deal is already recorded as sent, the workflow follows the Already Sent route and does not send a second welcome email.
6	Brevo sends the customer welcome email. A failed send is written to the error log and later stages do not continue.
7	HubSpot is updated to record the completed handoff. If the update fails, HubSpot Update Failed is logged.
8	Google Sheets receives an Email Sent row. This record is used by the duplicate check on future runs.
9	Brevo sends an internal handoff email to the team. If it fails, Internal Email Failed is logged.

Control points

- Contact exists before any customer email can be sent.
- Email exists before any customer email can be sent.
- Deal ID is not already present in the sent log.
- Failures are routed to visible log outcomes instead of being treated as silent success.

Duplicate prevention note

Duplicate prevention is based on the HubSpot deal ID stored in Google Sheets. This protects normal operation, but it is not transactional: if the Email Sent log write fails after Brevo has already sent the message, a later run could send again.

3. Planned acceptance criteria

These are project acceptance criteria for the portfolio build. They are not measured client results.

- A customer welcome email is sent only when the contact, email and duplicate checks all pass.
- The same HubSpot deal does not receive two welcome emails in normal operation.
- Every stop or failure is recorded with a clear reason.
- HubSpot is updated after a successful customer handoff.
- The internal team receives a handoff email after the main customer-facing steps complete.

4. Example implementation plan

The following is an example eight-working-day implementation plan for a project of this scope. It is not a claim about a real client engagement.

Phase	Day	What happens
1. Requirements	Day 1	Map handoff steps, required data and the log structure.
2. HubSpot trigger & data	Day 2	Set up Closed Won detection, deal retrieval and contact association lookup.
3. Validation	Day 3	Build the contact-exists and email-exists routers.
4. Duplicate check	Day 4	Search the deal ID in Google Sheets before any customer send.

Phase	Day	What happens
5. Email & CRM update	Day 5	Configure Brevo welcome email, HubSpot update and internal email.
6. Error logging	Day 6	Add error routes and log outcomes for failed steps.
7. Testing & fixes	Day 7	Test missing contact, missing email, duplicates and failed actions.
8. Documentation	Day 8	Document the workflow, limitations, risks and next steps.

5. Testing and validation

The scenario was tested with demonstration records. Testing focused on the main success path and the branches that should stop or log the handoff.

- Closed Won deal with a valid associated contact and email.
- Closed Won deal with no associated contact.
- Associated contact exists but has no email address.
- Deal ID already exists in the Google Sheets sent log.
- Customer email failure route.
- HubSpot update failure route.
- Internal email failure route.

Testing status

The workflow is a functional portfolio demonstration tested with demo records. It has not been deployed or monitored in a live client environment.

6. Project risks and current limitations

Risk	What could happen	Priority	Mitigation / next step
No contact or email	The handoff stops without customer communication.	Critical	Two validation routers stop the flow and log the reason.
Duplicate processing	The customer could receive the welcome email twice.	Critical	Check HubSpot deal ID in the sent log before sending.
Log write fails after send	Duplicate protection may not catch a later run.	High	Known limitation; use a stronger processed-deal record in a future version.
Brevo or HubSpot action fails	Customer communication or CRM state is incomplete.	High	Dedicated error routes write the failure to the log.
Errors are logged but not repaired	A failed handoff may remain unresolved.	Medium	Future version: retries, queue and owner notification.
Personal data in logs	Privacy/GDPR exposure.	Medium	Store only necessary data and review access/retention before production.

Additional limitations

- Google Sheets is a simple log and duplicate-check store, not a transactional production database.
- The email check confirms that a value exists; it does not prove deliverability or verify that the address belongs to the right person.
- The current error routes record failures but do not automatically retry or repair them.
- No onboarding task/ticket is created after a successful handoff.
- The workflow does not yet vary the handoff by service type, deal size or responsible owner.

7. Planned improvements

- Use a HubSpot property or structured database as a stronger processed-deal record.
- Add automatic retries and an error queue for failed Brevo or HubSpot actions.
- Notify the deal owner directly when a handoff fails.
- Create an onboarding task or ticket after a successful handoff.
- Use different email templates by service type, deal size or responsible team.
- Add monitoring for delayed or incomplete handoffs.
- Review privacy, data retention and access rules before production use.

8. Interview quick recap

What did you build?	A Make.com customer handoff workflow triggered by HubSpot Closed Won.
What is the key control?	The workflow validates contact/email data and checks the deal ID before sending the welcome email.
How do you prevent duplicates?	The HubSpot deal ID is searched in a Google Sheets sent log before the customer email step.
How are failures handled?	Dedicated routes log missing data and failed actions so the reason is visible.
Biggest limitation?	The sent log is not transactional. A failed log write after a successful email could allow a later duplicate send.
Production next step?	Use a stronger processed-deal record, automatic retry/error queue, owner notifications and production monitoring.

Portfolio transparency: This case study demonstrates workflow design, validation, duplicate prevention, error handling and documentation. It should not be presented as a live-client deployment or as evidence of measured business results.